

FREE WEEKLY STUDY GUIDE

DEVOTION
in Season

WEEK 4 OF 8 · 25 TO 30 OCTOBER 2026

Would Outsiders Vouch for You?

Running a Christian Business with a Good Name

SERIES: THE INFLUENTIAL SPIRIT
FOR PERSONAL STUDY, SMALL GROUPS AND TEAMS AT WORK

with Eryeza Kalalu

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This Week at a Glance

This guide goes with Sunday's podcast and the five Devotion in Season Daily episodes that follow it. On your own it takes about twenty minutes. With a small group or a team at work, allow about forty-five. Read the passages slowly, answer honestly, and use the space provided to plan your feedback conversation.

This week's podcast begins by honouring the people who died at Kiteezi, on the northern edge of Kampala, Uganda's capital. Kiteezi had been the city's main landfill since 1996, with family homes close around it. Early on 9 August 2024, during heavy rain, the mountain of waste collapsed and buried houses and the people inside them. At least thirty-five people died. Reports of the toll differ, and some sources give a higher number. Hundreds more lost their homes. Each one who died was known and loved by God. Jesus said in Luke 13:4–5 that people killed in a disaster were not worse sinners than anyone else, and this guide draws no lesson from their deaths. If you lost someone at Kiteezi, we grieve with you.

God cares how the people outside the church see His people. A good name is built through promises kept and rebuilt through honest confession, and Christ gives us His name before we have earned any name of our own.

SUN 25 OCT	Podcast: Running a Christian Business: Would Outsiders Vouch for You?	<i>1 Timothy 3 · 1 Peter 2</i>
MON 26 OCT	Does Your Reputation Matter to God?	<i>1 Timothy 3:7</i>
TUE 27 OCT	When People Speak Against You	<i>1 Peter 2:12</i>
WED 28 OCT	How to Admit You Were Wrong	<i>Proverbs 28:13</i>
THU 29 OCT	Christian Money Habits: Debt and Testimony	<i>Romans 13:8</i>
FRI 30 OCT	A Good Name Is Better Than Riches: A Prayer	<i>Proverbs 22:1</i>

The podcast comes out on Sundays at 8 PM East Africa Time, around 1 PM on the US East Coast, and around midday from 1 November, when US clocks go back. Devotion in Season Daily comes out Monday to Friday at 6 AM East Africa Time, which is late the evening before in the United States. Watch or listen on YouTube, Spotify and [eryezakalalu.com](https://www.eryezakalalu.com).

READ

The Passages

“he must have a good testimony among those who are outside, lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.”

1 TIMOTHY 3:7 · NKJV

What it meant first. Paul had left Timothy, his younger co-worker, in Ephesus, a port city in what is now western Turkey, to deal with false teaching. Chapter 3 lists what to look for in an overseer, the person who would lead and teach the congregation, and the last item looks beyond the church door. “Those who are outside” are people who don’t belong to the church. Interpreters differ on how “reproach,” or public disgrace, connects with “the snare of the devil.” The verse is first about church leaders. Paul uses the same phrase in letters to whole churches (1 Thessalonians 4:12; Colossians 4:5), so the principle reaches every believer.

“having your conduct honorable among the Gentiles, that when they speak against you as evildoers, they may, by your good works which they observe, glorify God in the day of visitation.”

1 PETER 2:12 · NKJV

What it meant first. Peter wrote to believers scattered across Roman provinces in what is now Turkey, and he calls them “sojourners and pilgrims.” Many had left the festivals and habits of their old life, and their neighbours were “speaking evil of you” (4:4). “Gentiles” here means those unbelieving neighbours. Interpreters differ on whether “the day of visitation” is the final judgment or an earlier day when God visits people in mercy. Either way, the verdict belongs to God. Christ walked this road first, and Peter says He “committed Himself to Him who judges righteously” (2:23).

MY FEEDBACK CONVERSATION

The person I will ask, when I will ask them and the words I will use. Afterwards, write what you heard and what the Holy Spirit is showing you to do.

REFLECT

Five Questions

The questions move from easy to costly. In a group, give people time to answer, and let anyone pass who needs to. Please leave out names when you share stories.

1. If someone asked your customers, suppliers or colleagues to describe you in one word, which word do you think they would choose? Why that word?
2. Paul's list for church overseers ends with "a good testimony among those who are outside." Why do you think the opinion of unbelievers mattered so much to him?
3. Proverbs 3:28 says, "Do not say to your neighbor, 'Go, and come back, And tomorrow I will give it,' When you have it with you." Who is waiting on you for a payment, a reply or a finished job?
4. Peter tells slandered believers to keep doing good and to answer with meekness. When people have spoken against you, how have you responded, and what did you learn about your own heart?
5. Proverbs 28:13 says, "whoever confesses and forsakes them will have mercy." Is there a mistake you have been covering? What would it take to admit it early and put it right?

THE PRACTICE · ONE ACTION THIS WEEK

Ask one client, supplier or colleague for honest feedback. You might say, "What's one thing I could do better in how I work with you?" Then listen without defending yourself, and ask the Holy Spirit to show you what to do with what you hear.

WHEN YOU GET SOMETHING WRONG

SAY SO EARLY

Tell the people affected before someone else finds the mistake.

PUT IT RIGHT

Explain while you repair it: refund the money, replace the order or redo the work.

PROTECT THE LEAST POWERFUL

When there's a cost to share, look after the casual worker and the small supplier first.

Your standing with God rests on Christ's record: "For He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us, that we might become the righteousness of God in Him" (2 Corinthians 5:21). **Your safety matters.** If accusations at work have turned into threats, harassment or legal danger, write down what was said and when, get counsel from someone you trust and from a lawyer if you need one, and use the proper reporting channels. If debt has become crushing, talk to a pastor or a qualified financial adviser, and get legal help if a lender threatens you. If you are in danger or have had thoughts of harming yourself, contact emergency services or a crisis line right away.

GO DEEPER EACH MORNING

With the Daily Episodes

MON

Does Your Reputation Matter to God? · 1 Timothy 3:7

Who outside the church sees me often, and what have they seen in me?

TUE

When People Speak Against You · 1 Peter 2:12

Who has spoken against me, and what one good thing can I do for them today?

WED

How to Admit You Were Wrong · Proverbs 28:13

Which mistake will I admit today, and how will I put it right?

THU

Christian Money Habits: Debt and Testimony · Romans 13:8

Which debt have I been avoiding, and what honest date can I give?

FRI

A Good Name Is Better Than Riches · Proverbs 22:1

Pray the prayer below, and bring your name and the people you deal with to God.

PRAY

Lord Jesus, You made Yourself of no reputation for us. You were spoken against, and You never answered with evil. Thank You for giving me Your name before I had any good name of my own. Where I've made promises I didn't keep, I'm sorry. Show me who I need to call, pay or apologise to. Father, we pray for the families of Kiteezi. Comfort those who still grieve, give homes and help to those who lost them, and give justice and wisdom to those responsible for keeping our cities safe. Holy Spirit, build in me a name that honours Christ among the people outside the church. When I'm spoken against, keep me from bitterness. In the mighty name of Jesus. Amen.

FROM THE BOOK

Day 23 of *The Influential Spirit*, “The Invisible Foundation,” is built on Proverbs 10:9. The audiobook in my own voice comes with the Formation Bundle and the Complete Formation Edition at eryezakalalu.com, and launch prices end on Saturday 31 October.

Support this ministry. To help this teaching reach business owners trying to run honest companies with nobody to encourage them, give at eryezakalalu.com/give.

Next week: A new part of the series begins on 1 November with “When visibility outruns credibility” and Matthew 7:15–16. The Week 5 guide will be at eryezakalalu.com/study.